

still get the best price simply by understanding the store's retail cycle.

J from JsEverydayFashion.com explains a timeline:¹¹

Clothes go on the floor at full retail price. Old stuff is reduced. A few weeks later, new clothes are given a small discount. A few more weeks later, stores get ready for the next shipment and most of the store goes on sale.

It might be a good idea to use a coupon and snag that clothing item you want during its first round of discounts—that is, if there aren't too many left on the rack. Otherwise, you can play it safe and wait a few more weeks for the better deal.

READER TIP:

I have bought NEW clothes multiple times at our local Salvation Army and my mother-in-law and father-in-law always find the cutest new clothes at their thrift stores for all my kids. When I pulled out our winter clothes, I was amazed at how much we had simply from older kids giving us new clothes that didn't fit, birthday clothes that were too big...etc.

—Christina, CA

3. DON'T BE AFRAID TO TRY USED

It's easy to be turned off by something that is old, used, and unwanted by someone else. But just because you've had a bad experience at one yard sale, thrift store, or consignment shop, doesn't mean they're all bad. And that's from someone who doesn't particularly enjoy shopping at these places herself!

Here are the things to keep in mind at each venue:

- **Yard Sales** – These are great places to find gently and barely worn kids' clothes. Check Craigslist on Thursday to see where all the sales will be on Friday and throughout the weekend, then head out early for